

Executive Leadership Competency Rubric

A behaviorally-anchored 1–4 scale for 360-degree feedback (4 = highest). Adapted from Kouzes & Posner's Five Practices of Exemplary Leadership.

How to use this rubric. Each of the five practices below is defined by observable behavior at four levels. Levels are cumulative: a leader at Level 3 reliably does everything at Levels 1 and 2. Anchor every rating to specific things you have personally seen the leader do — not to intentions or reputation. The rubric is the shared reference behind the open-ended survey; raters describe behavior in words, and the rubric helps calibrate what 'strong' looks like.

1 — Developing	2 — Emerging	3 — Proficient	4 — Exemplary
Behavior is inconsistent or absent; creates gaps others must cover.	Behavior appears in easy conditions but breaks down under pressure.	Behavior is consistent and dependable across normal situations.	Sets the standard; behavior lifts others and holds under stress.

Competency	1 — Developing	2 — Emerging	3 — Proficient	4 — Exemplary
Model the Way <i>Aligns actions with stated values; sets a personal example of standards and integrity.</i>	Actions and stated values diverge; asks of others what they don't do themselves.	Espouses values but lets standards slip when convenient or under time pressure.	Consistently 'walks the talk'; keeps commitments and applies standards to self first.	Becomes the reference point for the team's values; visibly holds the line on standards even when costly.
Inspire a Shared Vision <i>Articulates a compelling future and enlists others' commitment to it.</i>	Communicates tasks only; people cannot state where the team is headed or why.	Describes a direction but it stays abstract; buy-in is passive or unclear.	Paints a clear, credible picture of the future that people can connect their work to.	Makes the vision personally meaningful to each person; others repeat and advance it on their own.
Challenge the Process <i>Seeks improvement, takes smart risks, and learns from setbacks.</i>	Defends the status quo; avoids risk and treats failure as blame.	Open to change when prompted, but rarely initiates it; setbacks stall momentum.	Actively looks for better ways of working and takes measured, well-reasoned risks.	Builds a culture of experimentation; turns failures into shared learning and faster iteration.
Enable Others to Act <i>Builds trust and collaboration; grows others' capability and autonomy.</i>	Hoards decisions and information; people feel controlled or bypassed.	Delegates tasks but retains real authority; collaboration depends on the leader's presence.	Delegates meaningfully, removes blockers, and fosters trust across the team.	Develops other leaders; the team performs strongly and independently even in the leader's absence.
Encourage the Heart <i>Recognizes contributions and sustains morale and momentum.</i>	Recognition is absent or only critical; effort goes unacknowledged.	Gives generic or infrequent praise; recognition feels routine.	Recognizes specific contributions promptly and connects them to what matters.	Creates genuine belonging and pride; celebration is authentic and reinforces the right behaviors.

Scoring note. Report scores by rater group (self, manager, peers, direct reports) rather than a single average — the gaps between groups are usually the most useful signal. Treat a difference of one full level or more between groups as a discussion point, not a verdict.